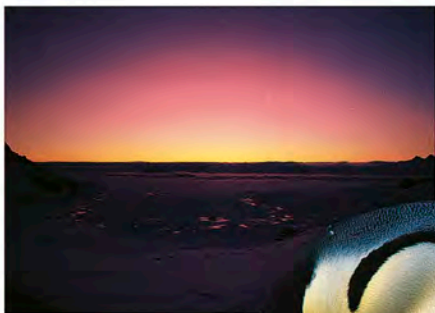




The longest night

Once the Antarctic winter sun sets, it is dark for more than six months.

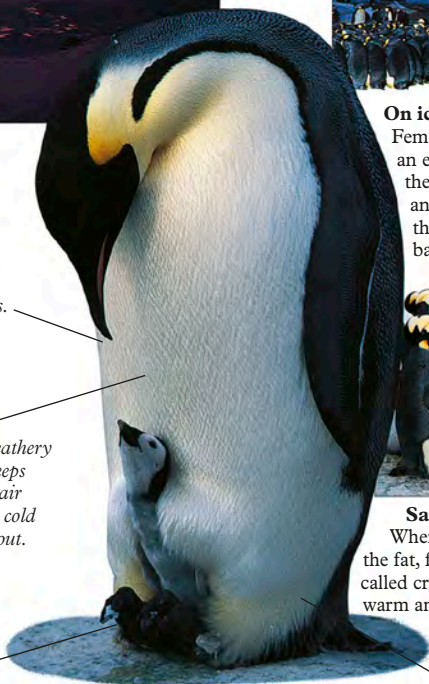
Male and female penguins cough up food from their stomachs to feed their chicks.



Emperor penguins are the biggest birds in Antarctica. They can be 4 feet (1.2 meters) tall.

Baby penguins keep warm by sitting on their parents' feet!

This feathery coat keeps warm air in and cold water out.



On ice

Female emperor penguins lay an egg at the start of winter. For the next 62-67 cold, dark days and nights, the male incubates this egg by standing still and balancing it on his feet.



Safety in numbers

When their parents are fishing, the fat, fluffy chicks form groups called crèches. This helps keep them warm and protects them from skuas.

Thick fat, called blubber, keeps penguins warm.

Penguins come to the surface to gulp down air about every 2-3 minutes.

Adelie penguins can swim at up to 20 miles (32 km) per hour.

By building up speed, they can shoot themselves out of the sea.



Leopard seals eat penguins.

